

Alice C.W. Huang

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EMPLOYMENT

- 07/2025– **Duncanson Chair in Ethics and Technology**
Assistant professor in computer science and philosophy
Western University (University of Western Ontario)
- 08/2024–06/2025 **Postdoctoral Fellow**
Harvard University

EDUCATION

- 09/2019–06/2024 **Ph.D., Philosophy**
University of Toronto
Dissertation committee: Jonathan Weisberg (chair), Jennifer Nagel, Boris Babic
David Savan Dissertation Prize
John Leyerle-CIFAR Prize for Interdisciplinary Research
- 09/2015–05/2019 **B.A., Philosophy**
New York University, Abu Dhabi, UAE
with minor in computer science
Summa Cum Laude

RESEARCH INTERESTS

AOS: AI ethics, formal social epistemology
AOC: Philosophy of science, philosophy of mind

PUBLICATIONS

1. HUANG, A. C. W., AND GROTE, T. Counterfactual explanations and the scope of contestability. *Synthese* (forthcoming)
2. WADE, K., LIZOTTE, D., AND HUANG, A. C. Fairness over time: Evaluating how fairness objectives shape health disparities in ai-driven clinical decision support systems. In *Proceedings of the Nineth AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society* (2026)
3. HUANG, A. C. W. Learning to be epistemic altruists. *Philosophy of Science* (2026)
4. HUANG, A. C. The efficiency of hyping. *Erkenntnis* (2026), 1–18
5. GROTE, T., AND HUANG, A. C. Fixing foundational concepts in machine learning: a methodological primer. *Synthese* 207, 3 (2026), 119

6. HUANG, A. C. W. Landscapes and bandits: A unified model of functional and demographic diversity. *Philosophy of Science* (2024)
7. HUANG, A. C. W. Track records: A cautionary tale. *The British Journal for the Philosophy of Science* (2024)
8. HUANG, A. C. W. A normative comparison of threshold views through computer simulations. *Synthese* 200, 4 (2022), 1–23

CONFERENCES

Invited

1. *Invited speaker at the Philosophy Meets Machine Learning Workshop*
2026 The International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) (July 6-11) in Seoul, Korea.
2. *(How) Does Accountability Require Understanding Machine Learning Models?*
2026 Work in progress workshop on Philosophy of AI (June 22-23) in Philadelphia, PA, USA.
3. *Emergence of Wisdom of Crowds*
2026 Philosophy of Complexity Science Conference (May 15-16) in Irvine, CA, USA.
4. *Contestability and Counterfactual Explanations*
2026 Upstate Workshop on AI and Human Values (April 24) in Rochester, NY, USA.
5. *What, Really, Are Simple Models Good For?*
2025 University of Guelph CARE-AI speaker (November 14) in Guelph, ON, Canada.
2026 University of Manitoba colloquium speaker (November 21) in Winnipeg, MB, Canada.
6. *The Efficiency of Hypes*
2026 Hong Kong University colloquium talk (January 29) in Hong Kong. 2025 CMU Formal Model in Metascience workshop (August 2-3) in Pittsburgh, PA, USA.
7. *Simple Models are not the Panacea*
2025 Northeastern AIDE summer school lecture series (June 17) in Boston, MA, USA.
8. *An Encroachment Account of Gaslighting*
2025 UMass Amherst MAP colloquium (March 14) in Amherst, MA, USA.
9. *Compete to Cooperate*
2025 Formal and Experimental Philosophy conference (FAX4) (April 24-25) in Buffalo, NY, USA.
2025 Self-Assembling Games Workshop (January 24-25) in Irvine, CA, USA.
10. *Landscapes and Bandits: A Unified Model of Functional and Demographic Diversity*
2024 Computational Social Philosophy Seminars (September 23) online.
11. *Taking Risks on a Budget*
2022 Self, Belief, and AI Workshop (July 19) in Toronto, ON, Canada.

Refereed

1. *Caught in Epistemic Factions*
2026 Canadian Philosophical Association Congress (June 6-9). Halifax, NS, Canada.

2. *Simple Models are not the Panacea*
2025 European Philosophy of Science Association meeting (August 27-30). Groningen, Netherlands.
3. *Compete to Cooperate*
2024 Philosophy of Science Association Biannual Meeting (November 14-17). New Orleans, USA.
4. *You Can Have Fairness and Accuracy Too*
2024 The Taiwan Association for Logic, Methodology and Philosophy of Science and Technology Annual Conference (June 8-9). Taipei, Taiwan.
5. *Track Records: A Cautionary Tale*
2023 Canadian Philosophical Association Meeting (May 29-June 1). Toronto, Canada.
2023 Taiwan Philosophical Logic Colloquium (December 9-11). Taipei, Taiwan.
6. *Homophily and the Meta-expertise of Experts*
2022 Schwartz Reisman Institute Graduate Workshop (June 20-22). Online.
7. *Deflationism Does Not Entail That Metaphysical Dependence is Irreflexive*
2023 The Aristotelian Society Joint Session (July 7-9). London, UK.
2022 Canadian Philosophical Association Meeting (May 17-20). Online due to COVID-19.
8. *Same But Different: Irreflexivity and Identity Dependence*
2022 American Philosophical Association Central Division Meeting (February 23-26) in Chicago.
2021 Durham Mind, Language, and Metaphysics Graduate conference (May 13-15). Online due to COVID-19.
9. *Normative Sensitivism*
2021 Edinburgh Graduate Epistemology Conference (August 9-10). Online due to COVID-19.
2021 Graduate Philosophy Conference at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (Apr 30 - May 1). Online due to COVID-19.
10. *Gerrymandering 'Structure'*
2019 Mind, Language and Action Group Graduate Conference III (April 10-12) in Porto, Portugal.

Comments

1. Comments on *The Epistemic Value of Imagination* by Jill Cumby
2023 Canadian Philosophical Association meeting (May 29-June 1) in Toronto, Canada.
2. Comments on *Plenitude and Modal Paradox* by Adam Murray
2023 at the University of Toronto.
3. Comments on *Resolute and Correlated Bayesians* by Babic *et al.*
2022 Formal Epistemology Workshop (May 27-29) in Irvine, USA.

GRANTS

Computational Strategies Against Opinion Factionalization (COSMOS Institute Truth Seeking Grant, as PI, \$6,000 USD, 2025-26)

Beyond the Accuracy-Interpretability Tradeoff: Optimizing Human-AI Collaborations (SSHRC Insight Development Grant, as PI, \$69,882, 2025-7)

The Future of Ethical AI (SSHRC Connection Grant, as co-applicant, \$17,635, 2025)

HONORS, AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

John Leyerle-CIFAR Prize for Interdisciplinary Research (\$1,000, 2025)

David Savan Dissertation Prize (\$1,000, 2024)

Schwartz Reisman Institute for Technology and Society Graduate Fellow (\$7,500, 2023-24)

Pronovost Morgan Family Foundation Fellowship in Ethical AI (\$5,000/year, 2022-24)

Ontario Graduate Scholarship (International) (\$15,000, 2023-24)

Graduate Student Service Award (\$1,000, 2023)

Herman Fellowship for international students (\$5,000, 2022-23)

New York University honors scholar award (2019)

New York University Abu Dhabi Bursary (~\$78,000/year, 2015-19)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

As Instructor

1. Data, Decisions and Dilemma: Ethics of Machine Learning (Fall 2025 & 2026, grad seminar)
2. Ethical Issues in Big Data (Spring 2024, upper year undergraduate course)
3. Persons, Minds and Bodies (Summer 2023, 2nd year undergraduate course)

Course Development in Embedded Ethics

1. Computational Properties in Interpretable Machine Learning
2. Data Science 1
3. Reinforcement Learning
4. Machine Learning
5. Discrete Math
6. Differential Privacy

SERVICE

Reviewer for: *AI & Society*, *British Journal for the Philosophy of Science*, *Philosophy of Science*, *Erkenntnis*, *Ergo*, *FAccT 2025*, *2026*, *European Journal for the Philosophy of Science*, *EAAMO 25*

Appointment committee (2025-26)

Philosophy department climate committee (2022-23)

Philosophy department women's caucus co-organizer (2022-23)

Women empowerment in STEM co-organizer (2017)

LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), French (fluent)

PROGRAMMING

Python, R, java, php, SQL, Stata, Javascript (in the order of proficiency)

REFERENCE

Jonathan Weisberg jonathan.weisberg@utoronto.ca

Jennifer Nagel jennifer.nagel@utoronto.ca

Boris Babic boris.babic@utoronto.ca

August 20, 2026